

Akshay Danthi

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SKILLS

[ML and GenAI model Evaluation techniques](#), Feature Engineering, [Retrieval-Augmented Generation \(RAG\)](#), MLOps, AI Ethics and Fairness, [Agentic AI](#) (+CrewAI), Integrating Small Language Models (SLMs), ML/DL/GenAI foundations, Tableau, SQL, Python, PRDs, GTM, Market Research, Competition Analysis, Cross Functional Collaboration, Prioritization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fractional AI Product Manager

August 2024 - Present

- Developing MVPs, PRDs and GTM strategies to help GenAI-driven pre-seed startups secure funding & scale effectively.
- Applying data-driven market research to define USPs, ICPs, and align products with market trends & customer needs.

Product Manager

March 2022 - August 2023

Mastercard

Remote

- Accelerated the onboarding of Issuer partners and Affiliates to Mastercard's new **cloud-native, multi-API** parameter configuration platform, increasing the **weekly User Onboarding rate by 5X**, from 10 users/week to over 50 users/week by effectively integrating Product Analytics & optimizing onboarding workflows.
- Elicited requirements from 15+ international stakeholders to create a unified **Product Vision**, then led a 9-member tech team (consisting of Development, Quality Assurance, UI/UX, Program Management teams) towards **Agile implementation** of this vision, achieving an **85% Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)** score.
- Reduced **Time to Market by 30%** for External Customers (Issuers and Affiliates) through automated workflows and standardized onboarding procedures. Criteria for Time to Market was for a parameter configuration setup to go Live.
- Boosted **API adoption rate by 35%** among Internal Customers (Downstream systems) through training workshops, extensive user feedback sessions, and iterative improvements.

Business Analyst

November 2019 - March 2022

HSBC

Remote

- Implemented the digital transformation of the Payment engines of **2 countries** (UK & KSA) by **eliciting business & technical requirements** from the Users, Subject Matter Experts & other stakeholders and **prioritizing them** effectively
- Delivered strategic contributions leading to a minimum of **10% reduction** in Capital Expenditures (**CapEx**) and Operating Expenses (**OpEx**), while improving **dynamic scaling** and adherence to **data sovereignty** standards.

Software Engineer

November 2017 - November 2019

Lloyds Banking Group

Hyderabad, India

- Developed Java & SQL solutions to optimize high-volume SWIFT payment processing, reducing traffic by 30%.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Business Analytics

August 2023 – August 2024

Golden Gate University

San Francisco, CA

Relevant Coursework: ML for Predictive Analytics, Enterprise Performance Management & Metrics, Business Intelligence, Big Data Ecosystems, Visualization & Communication, Managing Data Structures, Advanced Statistical Analysis

RELEVANT SIDE PROJECTS

- [1] Successfully completed a 4-weeks [AI/ML Product Management](#) specialization program.
- [2] [My portfolio site](#) features my learning notes on (AI) Product Management, PRDs, PM Case Studies, live projects (incl. a [GenAI service](#) that identifies distinct User Personas from Reddit product reviews using CrewAI's Agent-based RAG system).
- [3] Completed a [certification in Product Analytics](#), offered by MixPanel, where I built a marketing funnel.